



“... we have to win, or come back and face a thrashing!”

■ **Did your lecturers, or anyone from Microsoft, help you?**

(All laugh) **Jyotsna:** This year, the college gave us 17 days of attendance, and that was the biggest help!

Abhijeet: Well, the lecturers could not help us much in this regard. The syllabus covers C and C++, and I guess we needed much more than that!

Tejas: Hardware! The college lent us an O2 XDA! Microsoft was helpful too.

Last year, Homi Bhadra (a software architect with Microsoft) mentored us. We have been in touch with him over the past year, and this year we continue to seek his guidance.

■ **Who does what in Geek4?**

Jyotsna: Abhijeet and Tejas are the core coders.

Tejas: Sailesh and Jyotsna worked on the presentation.

■ **Surely there were some hurdles?**

Tejas: Administrative! (They all smile) Last year, we informed the college pretty late and had to run around a bit to get the paperwork in place. Oh yes, they confiscated my cell phone too! (He still hasn't got it back!)

Jyotsna: The entire project took shape at Sailesh's home.

Abhijeet: Thanks to Sailesh's folks, we got the whole place to ourselves.

Jyotsna: And I was allowed to come home by 10 pm or later!

■ **How were you judged?**

Tejas: We are marked on five parameters—smartness, innovation, commercial value, social responsibility and presentation.

■ **How were the Bangalore finals?**

Jyotsna: We won on the smartness and innovative quotient, but not before Tejas' laptop crashed.

Tejas: (Laughing away) Have you ever heard of a Pentium 4 laptop with 512 MB of RAM crashing? This one did!

■ **How were you guys rewarded?**

Tejas: We all won pocket PCs. Microsoft has promised to give us Longhorn when it is launched!

Sailesh: Microsoft gave us licensed copies of their operating system, Visual Studio, Office... all of that! We have no pirated copies of any software!

■ **So what's the agenda for Brazil? Any more tweaking or fine-tuning?**

Tejas: We have to refine our Idea Search and make it customisable. A mouse for a medical student and a computer professional would hold different meanings. There are some really good teams and this time, we have to win, or come back and face a thrashing!

■ **What else will happen at Brazil?**

Abhijeet: Well, the competition is going to be held at São Paulo...

Tejas: ...which is just 200-odd Km away from Rio...

Sailesh: Oh yes, Brazil, Rio...

■ **Post-Brazil, what do you plan to do?**

Tejas: We've all got jobs...

■ **And the big picture...what do you folks have in mind?**

Abhijeet: Coding...

Tejas: Coding, of course...Longhorn!

Jyotsna: Thinking about taking an MBA...

Sailesh: Well, not thought too much...love maths, thinking of studying that.

■ **Open Source, anyone?**

Abhijeet: No particular preference, I am comfortable with anything.

Jyotsna: Ditto.

Tejas: Closed source. I was (emphasises on 'was') playing around a bit with Linux, but now its .NET. So yes, totally closed source.

Sailesh: Same here.

■ **Why closed source?**

Tejas: I get to hide my bugs!

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